# ARCH-305 : Arch & Town Planning

Pre-Historic Architecture

# Prehistoric Architecture

**Stone age Paleolithic (Old Stone Age -** 12,000 years ago**)**

- Appeared first in Africa and are marked by the steady development of stone tools

**Mesolithic (Middle Stone Age -** 5,000 BC (before Christ)

- Period of the Stone Age intermediate between the Paleolithic and the Neolithic periods, characterized by adaptation to hunting, collecting, and fishing economy based on the use of forest, lakeside, and sea shore environments

**Neolithic (New Stone Age -** 4500 and 3000 BC

- Characterized by the development of agriculture and the making of polished stone implements

# Dwellings and Misc. Structures

Among prehistoric remains of archaeological interest, but of little architectural value, are:-

1. Natural Caves
2. Monoliths
3. Dolmens
4. Mud structures
5. Tumuli
6. Lake dwellings/Pile Structures
7. Wattle-and-Daub Dwellings

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1. Natural Caves

- Among the first shelters to be used by the prehistoric man was the natural cave.‡The natural caves gave the idea of supporting a roof slab by walls of stones which led to the construction of other types of dwellings.

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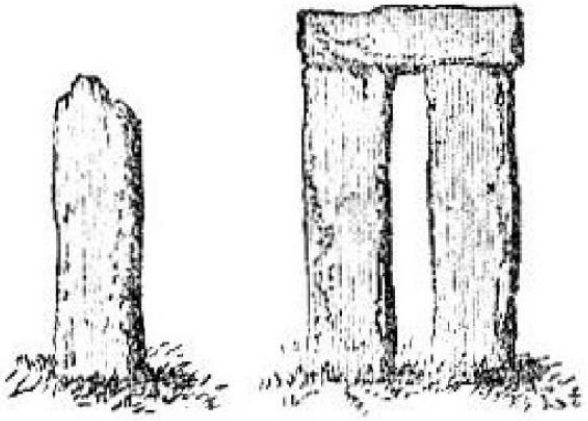


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## 2. Monoliths :

- Are single upright stones, known in Western France as " menhirs," (Maen, a stone, hir-high), such as those at Carnac in Brittany

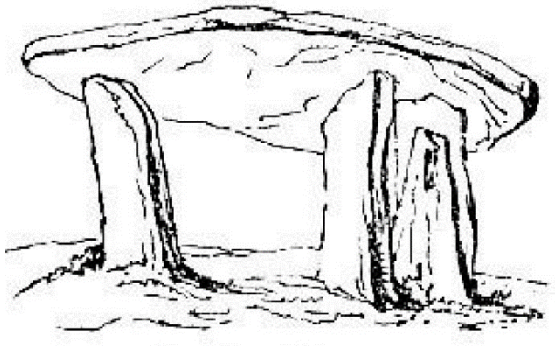




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## 2- Dolmens and Cromlechs :

- (dol = table + maen stone) and Cromlechs (crom = bent + leac = flat stone) are often used as interchangeable terms.
- **Dolmen** is the name sometimes applied to two or more upright stones supporting a horizontal slab.

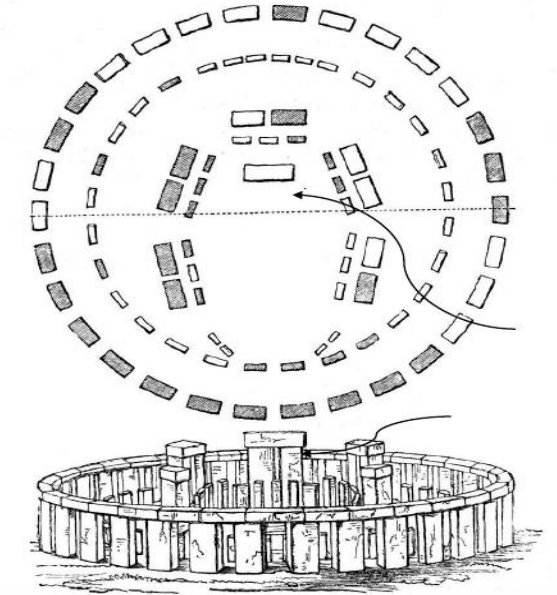


- **Cromlech**

Has been used for three or more upright stones, capped by a flat stone, as at, Kit's Coty House, Maid stone, and other places in England, Wales, Ireland, Northern France, and India.

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- These dolmens or cromlechs often stand within sacred circles of massive monoliths, supporting horizontal slabs, as at Stonehenge.- It seem to be erected by primitive people for the worship of the sun





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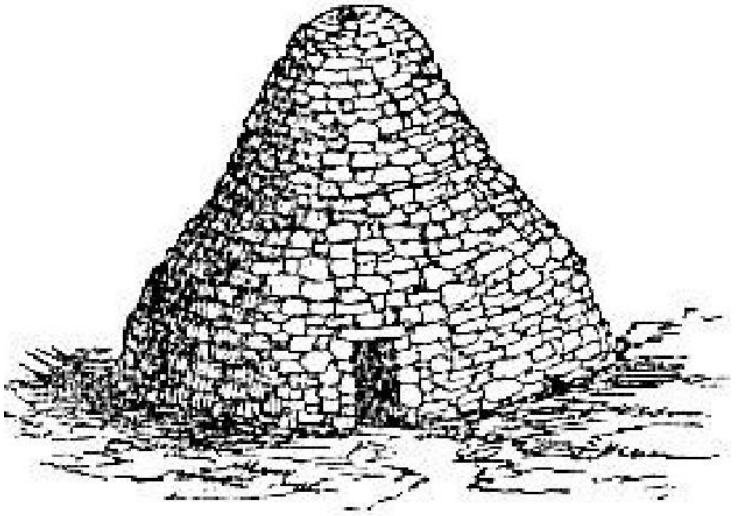
3 -Mud-Brick Structures

Mud-Brick Structures were also found in this style‡ Roofs of these buildings were also constructed out of local materials, such as a hard grass or wood.‡Circular, Rectangular and square shaped dwellings were found

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## 4-Tumuli or burial mounds

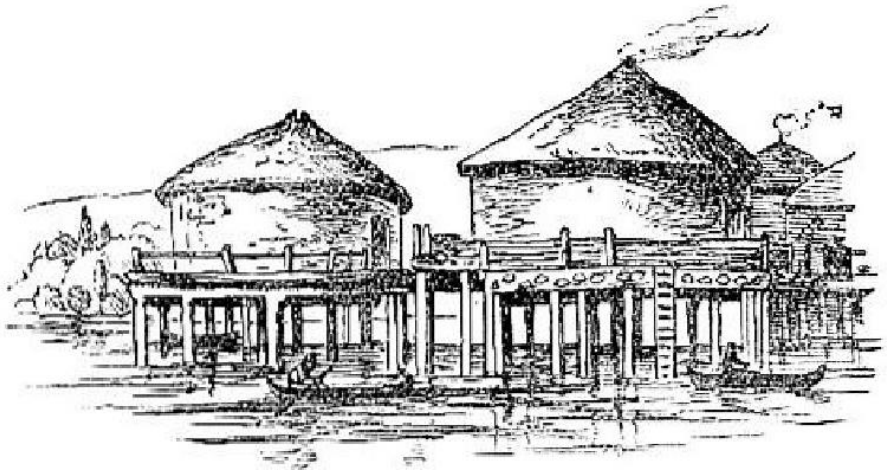
were probably prototypes of the Pyramids in Egypt and of the beehive huts in Wales, Cornwall, Scotland , and Ireland.

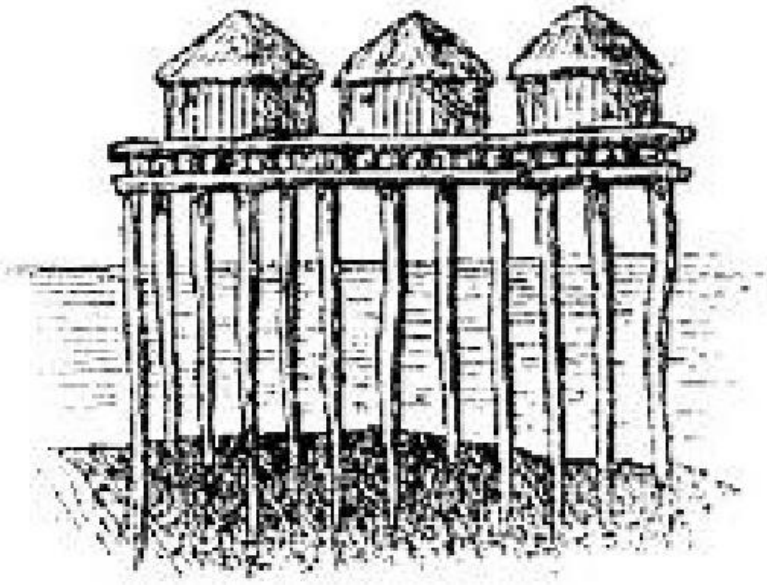


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## 5- Lake dwellings/Pile Structures:

Consisted of wooden huts built on piles in the water for protection against attack





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6-Wattle-and-Daub Dwellings‡

Neolithic settlements included wattle-and-daub structures with thatched roofs and floors made of logs covered in clay

